

EMIL BAKKENSEN JOHANSEN

EDUCATION AND ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Digital Democracy Centre, U. of Southern Denmark

Postdoctoral researcher

2025 -

- Research area: Computational Social Science, AI in Society and Organizations

Department of Business and Management, U. of Southern Denmark

PhD in Business Economics

2022 - 2025

- Research group: Strategic Organization Design (SOD)
- PhD supervisor: Professor Oliver Baumann
- Research area: Computational Social Science and Strategic Management
- PhD project: *Complex Dynamics in Digital News Ecosystems: Collaboration and Imitation in the Age of AI*

Department of Sociology, U. of Copenhagen

MSc in Sociology

2019 - 2021

- Specialization: Knowledge, Organization, and Politics
- Core topics: Digital Sociology and Social Movements
- Master's thesis supervisor: Associate Professor Mathias Wullum Nielsen
- GPA: 11.3

University of Texas at Austin

Exchange student

2017

- Core topics: Sociology and Media Studies

Department of Sociology, U. of Copenhagen

BSc in Sociology

2015 - 2019

- GPA: 9.0

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Computational Social Science
- AI
- Digital News
- Imitation
- Platform Ecosystems
- Inter-organizational Collaboration
- Social Movements

PUBLICATIONS AND WORKING PAPERS

1. **Emil Bakkensen Johansen**, Oliver Baumann. "AI-driven imitation can increase semantic diversity in news while omitting source information." *arXiv*: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2503.16021>. *Revise and resubmit at Nature Human Behavior*.
2. **Emil Bakkensen Johansen**, Oliver Baumann. "Platform Reliance: How External Producers' Use of Platform Content Shapes Product Similarity." *SSRN working paper*: https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=5178352. *Revise and resubmit at Strategic Management Journal*.
3. Lyng Asbjørn Møller, **Emil Bakkensen Johansen**, Claes de Vreese. "Detecting AI Under Uncertainty: Evidence from a Survey Experiment with Danish Journalists." *Revise and resubmit at New Media and Society*.
4. David Wegmann, **Emil Bakkensen Johansen**, Claes de Vreese, Rebecca Adler-Nissen, Anja Bechmann. "Platforms and Information Disorders." *In-press report for the Danish Ministry of Research, Higher Education and Digital Affairs*.
5. **Emil Bakkensen Johansen**, David Wegmann, Anja Bechmann, Claes de Vreese. "Gender-differential effects of manosphere content." *Work-in-progress*.
6. **Emil Bakkensen Johansen**, Therese Whalen Sandberg, Curd Knüpfer, Josephine Lukito, Lena Frischlich, Hannah Decker, Troels Runge. "Danish elections 2026 in a high-choice information environment: Platforms, Fragmentation and AI." [Digital Democracy Centre Report](#).
7. **Emil Bakkensen Johansen**, Oliver Baumann. "Platform Bypass: Informal Collaboration and Ecosystem Adaptation in Crisis Times." *SSRN working paper*: <https://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5160253>. *To be submitted to Research Policy*.
8. **Emil Bakkensen Johansen**, Nicole Doerr, Mathias Wullum Nielsen. "Momentary Symbols: Tracing the Visual Expressions of Collectives." *Acta Sociologica*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/00016993251379164>
9. **Emil Bakkensen Johansen**, Janus Emil Mariager, Victor Kalsen Nielsen. 2021. "Revolution of Our Time: Surveillance and Materiality in the Hong Kong 2019 Protests." *SocArXiv*. <https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/sg2ne>

RESEARCH VISITS

Institute for Strategy, Technology, and Organizations (ISTO), LMU Munich 2022
Visiting PhD Student

- Hosted by Professor Tobias Kretschmer

AWARDS

- **ICA Journalism Division: Top Extended Abstract Award**, *Navigating Epistemic Uncertainty: The Effects of AI Threat Narratives on Journalists' Abilities to Detect AI-Generated Content* (with Lyng Asbjørn Møller and Claes de Vreese) 2026

GRANTS

- **Villum Synergy Initiation Project**, Contributor to application, 2026 N/A
- **DFF AI Thematic Call 2025**, Contributor to application, 2025 N/A
- **Villum Synergy Initiation Project**, Contributor to application, 2025 N/A
- **Strategic Management Society**, Scholarship, 2024 979 USD
- **SDU Research Foundation**, Research grant, 2023 36000 DKK
- **Danish Data Science Academy**, Travel grant, 2022 15000 DKK
- **Augustinusfonden**, Travel grant, 2022 16000 DKK
- **Torben og Alice Frimodts Fond**, Travel grant, 2022 20003 DKK
- **Christian og Otilia Brorsons Rejselegat**, Travel grant, 2022 5000 DKK
- **Otto Mønstedts Fond**, Travel grant, 2022 15000 DKK

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Reviewer for: *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*
Journal of Organization Design
European Management Review
Academy of Management Annual Meeting (TIM Division)
Schmalenbach Journal of Business Research

Shortlisting and assessment committee: *FOOD-FRAMES postdoc hiring process (with Lena Frischlich), U. of Southern Denmark 2025*

Panel Organizer and Moderator: *Job market workshop, U. of Southern Denmark 2025*

PhD Representative: *PhD Advisory Board, U. of Southern Denmark 2023-2025*

Organizer: *Strategic Organization Design (SOD) Seminar Series 2023-2025*

Co-editor: *Digital Democracy Centre SoMe Team 2022-2026*

TEACHING

Business Development (2022-2026)

Sessions:

- Niche Strategies for New Businesses
- Platform Strategies as Entrepreneurial Strategy
- Confronting Bigger, Established Rivals
- Value Chains and the Innovation Ecosystem
- Intrapreneurship and Corporate Strategy
- Strategic Renewal and Business Model Innovation

Examination:

- Written home assignments
- Written in situ exam assignments

Virksomhedens IT-værktøjer (2023, 2025)

Examination:

- Oral examination

Business Strategy (2025)

Examination:

- Written in situ exam assignments

INVITED TALKS AND SEMINARS

Organization Design Community | Online 2025

- Webinar: *Platform Reliance and Bypass: Organizational Design Tradeoffs in a News Ecosystem* with Oliver Baumann

Danish e-infrastructure Consortium (DeiC) Konferencen | Kolding, Denmark 2025

- Invited speaker: *Dataadgang som demokratisk problem: AI, reproducerbarhed og FAIR-principper*

CONFERENCES

- CS2Nordics, Nordic Society for Computational Social Science** | Copenhagen, Denmark 2026
- Paper session: *Auditing LLM voting conversations: A field study of how citizens use chatbots during the Danish parliamentary elections*
- Democracy and Digital Citizenship Conference, Aarhus University** | Aarhus, Denmark 2026
- Paper session: *When Voting Advice Becomes Conversational: A Field Study of Human-AI Interaction During an Election*
- Decentralization in Organizations Conference, INSEAD** | Fontainebleau, France 2026
- Paper session (presented by Oliver Baumann): *Platform Bypass: Informal Collaboration and Ecosystem Adaptation in Crisis Times*
- Machine+Behavior, Max Planck Institute for Human Development** | Berlin, Germany 2026
- Poster selected for plenary lightning talk: *Imitating AI agents increase semantic diversity in homogeneous information ecosystems but can reduce it in heterogeneous ones*
- COMPTExT, University of Birmingham** | Birmingham, UK 2026
- Accepted abstract: *Autonomous AI imitators increase diversity in homogeneous information ecosystems*
- Digital Democracy Workshop, University of Zurich** | Zurich, Switzerland 2025
- Paper session: *Autonomous AI imitators increase diversity in homogeneous information ecosystems*
- Academy of Management** | Copenhagen, Denmark 2025
- Paper session: *Platform Reliance: How Usage of Platform Content Shapes Product Similarity*
- Strategic Management Society** | Istanbul, Turkey 2024
- Paper session: *Multi-sided Platforms as Inverted Prisms: How Reliance on Base Products Affects End Product Similarity*
- Academy of Management** | Chicago, USA 2024
- Paper session: *Platform Bypass: Adaptation through Informal Collaboration in the Danish News Ecosystem*
- DRUID Academy** | Odense, Denmark 2024
- Paper session: *Orchestrator Bypass: Adaptation through Informal Collaboration in the Danish News Ecosystem*
- Nordic Network for the Science of Science** | Odense, Denmark 2024
- Attendance
- DRUID** | Lisbon, Portugal 2023
- Paper session: *Orchestrator Bypass: Adaptation through Informal Collaboration in the Danish News Ecosystem*
- IC2S2** | Copenhagen, Denmark 2023
- Selected plenary talk: *Momentary Symbols: Tracing the Visual Expressions of Protest Movements*
 - Poster presentation: *Orchestrator Bypass: Adaptation through Informal Collaboration in the Danish News Ecosystem*
- Democracy and Digital Citizenship Conference** | Roskilde, Denmark 2022
- PhD Workshop: *Orchestrator Bypass: Adaptation through Informal Collaboration in the Danish News Ecosystem*
- International Communication Association** | Paris, France 2022
- Attendance
- Nordic Network for the Science of Science** | Helsinki, Finland 2022
- Attendance

SKILLS	Languages: English, Danish	
	Programming: Python, R, VBA	
	Methods: Natural Language Processing (NLP), Network Analysis, Webscraping, Simulation, Econometrics, Qualitative interviews, Mixed Methods, Netnography	
WORK HISTORY	Digital Democracy Centre, U. of Southern Denmark	2025-
	<i>Postdoctoral researcher</i>	
	• Researching AI in society and organizations	
	Parental leave from PhD program	2023-2024
	<i>On leave for a total of 4.5 months</i>	
	Department of Business and Management, U. of Southern Denmark	2021-2025
	<i>PhD Fellow</i>	
	• Strategic Organization Design (SOD) research group • Affiliated with the Digital Democracy Centre (DDC)	
	VIVE - The Danish Center for Social Science Research	2019-2021
	<i>Student Assistant</i>	
	• Data collection, STATA coding, literature screening, and co-authoring reports	
	The National Board of Social Services	2018-2019
	<i>Student Assistant</i>	
REFERENCES	• Data collection, conducting surveys, administrative tasks	
	Available upon request from:	
	Oliver Baumann	
	Mathias Wullum Nielsen	
	Claes de Vreese	
	Lena Frischlich	
	Curd Knüpfer	